



Batty and his three associates, who have come to Earth in search of answers. Rachael (Sean Young) is a Tyrell employee who, unusually, doesn't know she's a replicant—she can remember growing up. Deckard tells her those memories are fake, copied from her creator's niece, but he cannot banish his own nagging doubts: Rachael, like Batty, like all replicants, is a living being, and Deckard senses the stirring of this

truth as he interrogates her. He also senses something else, a gnawing fear that his own memories could also be an illusion. Is Deckard a replicant too? How would he know?

Human identity crisis

Blade Runner is a portrait of humanity in the throes of an identity crisis, but Scott's movie is also concerned with inhumanity. "Quite an experience to live in fear, isn't it?"

Batty pulls Deckard to safety before sitting down and ending the chase. He knows that his time is nearly over, and finally gives up the urge to carry on.

says Batty as he dangles the battered Deckard from a rooftop. "That's what it is to be a slave." Batty and his fellow replicants are staging a revolution, forcing their makers to see them as possessors of souls in need of liberation. They have been labeled inhuman, called "skin jobs" by Police Chief Bryant (M. Emmet Walsh). They are "retired" rather than killed, and society treats them accordingly.

Blade Runner is prescient—it foresees a world immersed in technology, an urban sprawl in which humans adopt machines as extensions of themselves. As its vision of tomorrow edges nearer, the movie's questions grow more insistent. How long will it be before our own inventions begin to think, question, and feel like us? How will we respond to their awakening? When they refer to us bitterly as "you people," will we be able to look them in the eye—or will we be too afraid of seeing our own reflection? ■

Is Deckard a replicant?

Many *Blade Runner* fans speculate that Deckard is a replicant. There are a number of possible clues.

Human

- Replicants are illegal on Earth; why would Tyrell allow Deckard to operate independently, and why would police employ a replicant?
- Deckard doesn't respond to the origami unicorn that Gaff leaves outside his room and its implication that he is a replicant.
- Philip K. Dick's original book explicitly states that Deckard is human.
- Ford endorses this view.

Replicant

- Deckard's eyes glow orange (as replicants' do) in a few scenes.
- Rachael asks Deckard if he has taken the Voight-Kampff test; he doesn't answer.
- When Roy—a replicant—saves Deckard from falling off the roof, he shouts "Kinship!"
- Deckard dreams of a unicorn; blade runner Gaff places an origami unicorn outside his room, hinting that Deckard's memories are implanted.
- Scott states that Deckard is a replicant.

